

Installing and Configuring GitHub

GitHub is a file management system that does the following:

- Keeps your files in the cloud
- Easily maintains different versions of your code.
- Great for collaboration, keeps track of everyone's changes!

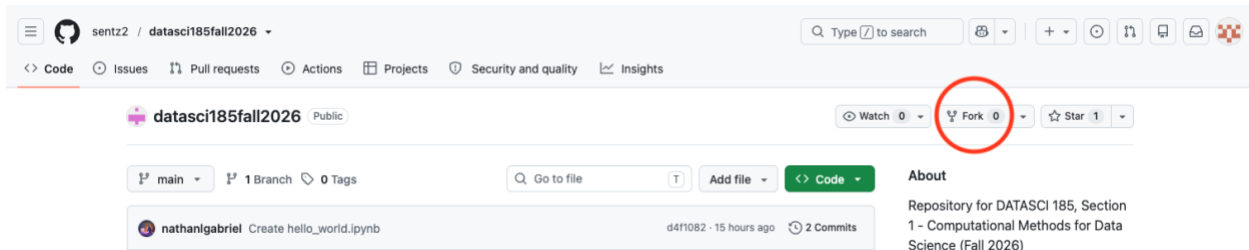
We will use GitHub to manage the lecture files.

Step 0: Basic Setup (only do once)

1. Go to <https://github.com/> and sign up for a GitHub account (if you don't already have one). Try to register with your Emory email since you sometimes get student benefits. Be careful selecting your username, this will be visible to the public.
2. Download the GitHub Desktop app from <https://github.com/apps/desktop>. Follow the default options in the installation process and use your newly created GitHub credentials.

Step 1: Add course repo to your account (only do once)

1. Sign into github.com using your account credentials.
2. Go to the website of the repository with the lecture notes:
<https://github.com/sentz2/datasci185fall2026>
3. Click on the "Fork" button near the top-right corner:



- You will be asked to make your own copy of the lecture notes. You can name them whatever you like, but I recommend using the same name as the repository “datasci185fall2026”:

Create a new fork

A fork is a copy of a repository. Forking a repository allows you to freely experiment with changes without affecting the original project.

Required fields are marked with an asterisk (*).

Owner *

fake-student-2026

Repository name *

datasci185fall2026

datasci185fall2026 is available.

By default, forks are named the same as their upstream repository. You can customize the name to distinguish it further.

Description

Repository for DATASCI 185, Section 1 - Computational Methods for Data Science (Fall 2026)

90 / 350 characters

☒ Copy the main branch only

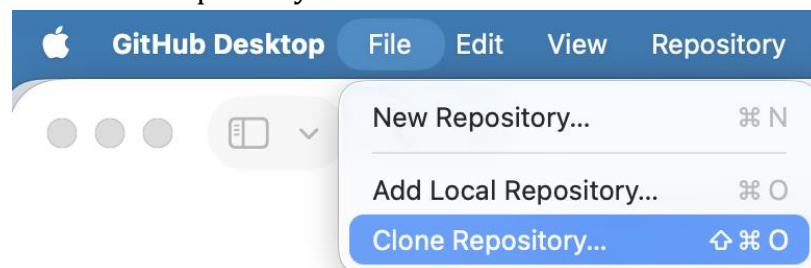
Contribute back to sentz2/datasci185fall2026 by adding your own branch. [Learn more.](#)

You are creating a fork in your personal account.

Create fork

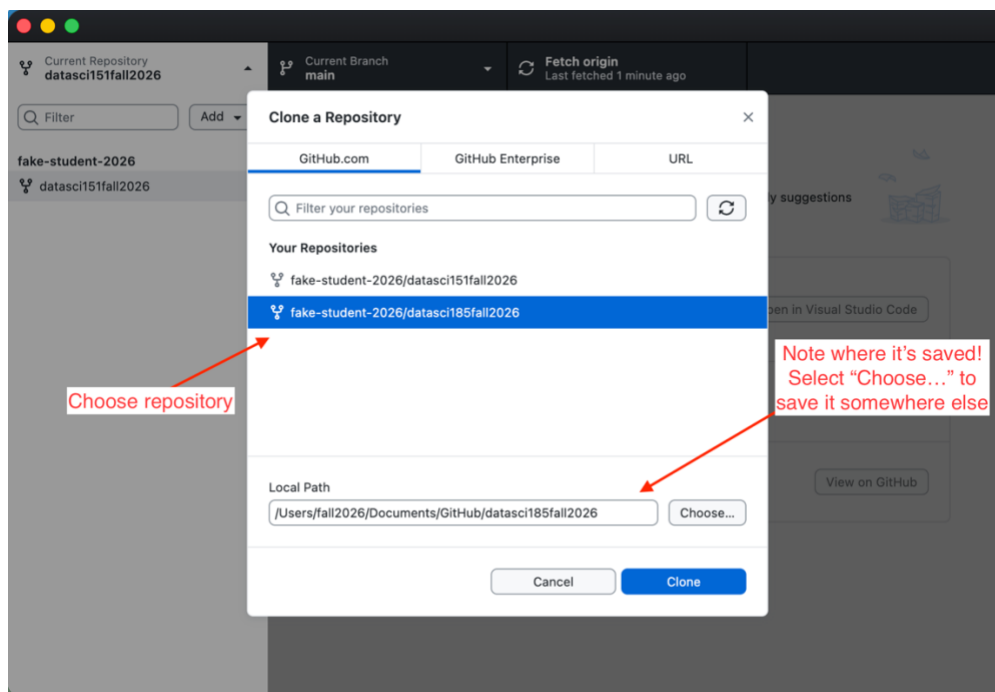
Step 2: Clone Repository on your Computer (only do once)

- Open the GitHub Desktop App.
- Click “File” then “Clone Repository”:

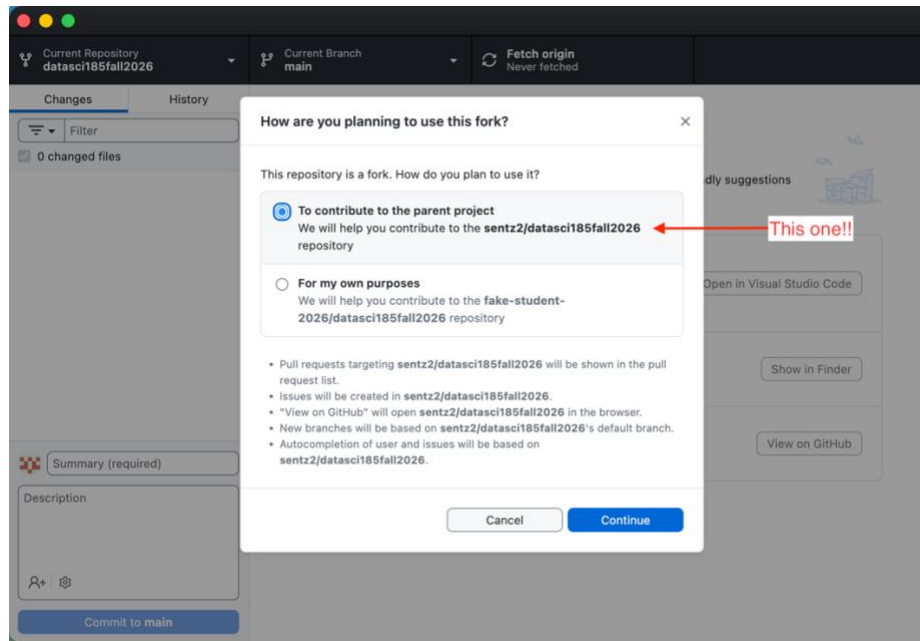


- At this point, you want to **think** before clicking anything. Choose the repository you want to clone (you most likely only have one option). In this case it would be “fake-student-2026/datasci185fall2026” (with your GitHub username instead of “fake-student-2026”)
 - Please note where you save the repo on your computer!** Select “Choose...” to choose the folder yourself.

- b. In the screenshot below, I am saving it to
/Users/fall2026/Documents/GitHub/datasci185fall2026”
- c. Avoid saving it in a subfolder of another file sharing system like One-Drive or Dropbox. This can sometimes cause issues.
- d. If you plan on using GitHub regularly in the future, try to store the repository in the same location where you will clone other repositories. You will need to access the Lecture Notes folder often during the semester. Again, **make sure you know where you’re saving it!**
- e. Finally, select the blue “Clone” icon to save the copy to your computer.



- 4. Next, select the option **“To contribute to the parent project”**. Note that you do **NOT** want to create the copy for your own purposes.
 - a. This option allows you to keep updating the lecture notes from the instructor’s repository.
 - b. The other option creates a local copy that has no links to the original repository. If you accidentally choose this option, you won’t be able to see any changes. To reverse: (a) remove the repository on your computer by right-clicking (Windows) or control+clicking (Mac) on the repository on the GitHub Desktop App, (b) manually delete the directory on your computer, (c) Go back to the “File -> Clone Repository” step.



You're done! You should have access to the lecture notes.